



position of the speaker in your room and adjust the sound accordingly, to eventually provide a more room-filling sound. Marshall has also added Night Mode which lowers louder sounds but ensures that quiet sounds are still clear and audible. I didn't find a tangible difference when connected to Bluetooth, but the feature seems to be aimed at HDMI usage, so it could be more effective with HDMI connection.

That aside, you get basic playback controls, the ability to update the firmware, and... that's about it. It is a pretty barebones app in terms of features. The same is true for the speaker as well; you've got a couple of features that work decently well, but that's about it.

PERFORMANCE

Behind the speaker grille of the Marshall Woburn III, you've got a 90 W Class D amplifier that powers a 6-inch woofer, dual 15 W amplifiers for the two 2-inch mid-range speakers, and dual 15W Class D amplifiers that drive the two 0.75-inch tweeters. The speaker supports a frequency range of 35 Hz - 20,000 Hz and is only compatible with the SBC codec. Here lies the gravest shortcoming of the Marshall Woburn III. It is hard to give Marshall a pass for the fact that the speaker doesn't come with aptX or LDAC codecs since it is priced at a whopping ₹59,999.

The drivers on the Marshall Woburn III pack a punch and are very capable,

however, the lack of LDAC or aptX means that you can't play hi-fidelity FLAC music to its full potential over Bluetooth. If you connect using a wired source, high-fidelity playback is possible, of course.

The speaker has a V-shaped sound signature with boosted lows and highs, however, they don't impact the clarity of the mids given the fantastic tuning of the drivers. The low-end has a nice punch to it, and instruments such as kick drums are driven with ease even at low volume levels. In *Another One Bites the Dust* by Queen, the low-end rumble sounds detailed and has a lot of presence without being overbearing.

I did notice that there is some discernible distortion at high volume levels though. The speaker gets extremely loud though, so you won't usually need to push it to maximum volume levels. In fact, it can encompass a large space with room-filling sound at 60-70 per cent volume. At these volume levels, the lows sound clean, the bass has great rumble, and the mids are detailed with sparkly highs to complement. It is not a flat sound profile, but it has character and is very enjoyable. LDAC or aptX codec support would definitely be a cherry on top, but alas, it is missing.

VERDICT

Luxurious and powerful, the Marshall Woburn III stuns with premium looks

and impactful sound at first. However, delve deeper and you'll find that at ₹59,999, there are quite a few misses. There's no aptX or LDAC codec support, which brings it down from the pedestal it could occupy in the premium speaker space. A great alternative is the AIWA RS-X150 Natsukasii Pro which comes with AAC and LDAC support and is also cheaper!

Additionally, the Marshall Woburn III lacks Wi-Fi or voice assistant support, which you get on speakers at half the price. What you won't get is the carefully crafted blend of classy and retro aesthetics that Marshall has mastered over the years. If looks are the most important to you, the Marshall Woburn III is one of the most artfully-designed speakers you can buy in 2023. For everything else, we have seen better.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

Speakers: 1x 90 W Class D amplifier for the 6" woofer, 2x 15 W Class D amplifiers for the 2" mid-range drivers, 2x 15 W Class D amplifiers for the 0.75" tweeters | Frequency range: 35 Hz - 20,000 Hz | Stereo/Mono: Stereo | Max. Sound Pressure Level: 100.5 dB @ 1 m | Power: 100-240 V | Wi-Fi: No | Connectivity: 3.5 mm, RCA, HDMI | Microphone: No | Bluetooth version: 5.2, Bluetooth LE Audio ready | Bluetooth range: 30 feet | Weight: 7.45 kg | Colours: Black, Cream

CONTACT

Company: Marshall (Luxury Personified LLP) | Phone: 1800-111-786 | Email: cs@luxurypersonified.in | Website: <https://www.marshallheadphones.com/in/en/>